Subject: September 28 BoS public participation.
From: Stephen Harrington <sth.alist@gmail.com>
Date: 9/28/26, 15:03
To: Stephen Harrington <stephenharrington@yahoo.com>

Good evening. My name is Stephen Harrington. I live at 74 Columbia Road here in Arlington.

Thank you for receiving my correspondence regarding a proposed remedy to a constititonally vunerable policy as described in your packets. Thank you also for respecting the Supervisor of Records appeal of a public records request to identify the residents excluded from petitioning Town Meeting by responding in a timely fashion.

Tonight, I want to return to the threshold question of **authority and accountability** in regards to identified resident electronic advocacy to Town Meeting.

Massachusetts law gives the Moderator authority to preside over Town Meeting and regulate its proceedings. But the Town's own records show the electronic submission system operating year-round as an administrative process involving Moderator approval, Clerk publication, and Town-maintained archives.

In 2024, the Moderator expressly agreed that my Article 14 submission was germane, but denied direct access because I was not a Town Meeting Member or official.

My question remains unanswered: **what statute, bylaw, Town Meeting vote, or lawful delegation created that authority over residents outside Town Meeting proceedings?**

There is also an accountability problem. The Guidelines give the Moderator final control over access, yet the Town Manager and Select Board say they cannot direct him, and no review process has been identified for an excluded resident.

A Town-operated communications and archival system should not create governmental authority without an identifiable source or responsibility without review.

I again request a written answer and a public agenda discussion.